National Transportation Safety Board
Aviation Accident Final Report

Location:	Northampton, MA	**Accident Number:**	MIA08CA045
Date & Time:	12/26/2007, 1700 EST	**Registration:**	N5425K
Aircraft:	Cessna 172P	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Defining Event:		**Injuries:**	2 None
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General Aviation - Instructional		

Analysis

The flight instructor stated that the student was to perform a short field takeoff. The student aligned the airplane on the centerline of the runway, applied the brakes, and increased engine power. The brakes were released and the airplane began the takeoff roll. The airplane suddenly veered off the centerline and struck a snow bank off the left side of the runway. The flight instructor stated that there were no mechanical failures or malfunctions to the airplane or any of its systems prior to the accident.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be: The student pilot's failure to maintain directional control of the airplane during the takeoff roll and inadequate supervision by the CFI.

Findings

Occurrence #1: LOSS OF CONTROL - ON GROUND/WATER
Phase of Operation: TAKEOFF - ROLL/RUN

Findings
1. (C) DIRECTIONAL CONTROL - NOT MAINTAINED - DUAL STUDENT
2. (C) SUPERVISION - INADEQUATE - PILOT IN COMMAND(CFI)

Occurrence #2: ON GROUND/WATER ENCOUNTER WITH TERRAIN/WATER
Phase of Operation: TAKEOFF - ROLL/RUN

Findings
3. TERRAIN CONDITION - SNOWBANK

Factual Information

Flight Instructor Information

Certificate:	Flight Instructor; Commercial	**Age:**	16, Male
Airplane Rating(s):	Multi-engine Land; Single-engine Land	**Seat Occupied:**	
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	Seatbelt, Shoulder harness
Instrument Rating(s):	Airplane	**Second Pilot Present:**	
Instructor Rating(s):	Airplane Single-engine	**Toxicology Performed:**	
Medical Certification:	Class 2	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	05/01/2007
Occupational Pilot:		**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	
Flight Time:	2609 hours (Total, all aircraft), 1500 hours (Total, this make and model), 95 hours (Last 90 days, all aircraft), 23 hours (Last 30 days, all aircraft)		

Student Pilot Information

Certificate:	Student	**Age:**	16, Male
Airplane Rating(s):	Single-engine Land	**Seat Occupied:**	
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	Seatbelt, Shoulder harness
Instrument Rating(s):	None	**Second Pilot Present:**	
Instructor Rating(s):		**Toxicology Performed:**	
Medical Certification:	Class 3	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	07/01/2007
Occupational Pilot:		**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	
Flight Time:	80 hours (Total, all aircraft), 78 hours (Total, this make and model), 5 hours (Last 30 days, all aircraft)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Cessna	**Registration:**	N5425K
Model/Series:	172P	**Aircraft Category:**	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:		**Amateur Built:**	No
Airworthiness Certificate:	Normal	**Serial Number:**	17274106
Landing Gear Type:	Tricycle	**Seats:**	
Date/Type of Last Inspection:		**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	
Time Since Last Inspection:		**Engines:**	1 Reciprocating
Airframe Total Time:		**Engine Manufacturer:**	Lycoming
ELT:		**Engine Model/Series:**	O-320-D2J
Registered Owner:	Five Star Flight Inc.	**Rated Power:**	
Operator:	Michael L. Foy	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	None
Operator Does Business As:	Five Star Flight Academy	**Operator Designator Code:**	

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual Conditions	**Condition of Light:**	Day
Observation Facility, Elevation:	KBAF	**Distance from Accident Site:**	
Observation Time:	1653 EST	**Direction from Accident Site:**	
Lowest Cloud Condition:	Clear	**Visibility**	
Lowest Ceiling:	None	**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	4 knots /	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	/
Wind Direction:	50°	**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	/
Altimeter Setting:	30.24 inches Hg	**Temperature/Dew Point:**	0°C / -4°C
Precipitation and Obscuration:	No Obscuration; No Precipitation		
Departure Point:	Northampton, MA (KBAF)	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	None
Destination:	Northampton, MA	**Type of Clearance:**	VFR
Departure Time:	EST	**Type of Airspace:**	

Airport Information

Airport:	Northampton (K7B2)	**Runway Surface Type:**	Asphalt
Airport Elevation:		**Runway Surface Condition:**	Dry
Runway Used:	32	**IFR Approach:**	None
Runway Length/Width:	3365 ft / 50 ft	**VFR Approach/Landing:**	Traffic Pattern

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	2 None	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Explosion:**	
Total Injuries:	2 None	**Latitude, Longitude:**	42.328056, -72.611389

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Jose Obregon	**Report Date:**	02/28/2008
Additional Participating Persons:			
Publish Date:			
Note:	This accident report documents the factual circumstances of this accident as described to the NTSB.		
Investigation Docket:	NTSB accident and incident dockets serve as permanent archival information for the NTSB's investigations. Dockets released prior to June 1, 2009 are publicly available from the NTSB's Record Management Division at pubinq@ntsb.gov, or at 800-877-6799. Dockets released after this date are available at http://dms.ntsb.gov/pubdms/.		

The National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB), established in 1967, is an independent federal agency mandated by Congress through the Independent Safety Board Act of 1974 to investigate transportation accidents, determine the probable causes of the accidents, issue safety recommendations, study transportation safety issues, and evaluate the safety effectiveness of government agencies involved in transportation. The NTSB makes public its actions and decisions through accident reports, safety studies, special investigation reports, safety recommendations, and statistical reviews.

The Independent Safety Board Act, as codified at 49 U.S.C. Section 1154(b), precludes the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an incident or accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report. A factual report that may be admissible under 49 U.S.C. § 1154(b) is available here.